📖 StoriesOfUs

Social Issue Storytelling Platform

"Empowering Voices, Inspiring Change: Share Your Story, Transform Communities."

A Web Application for Social Awareness

ABSTRACT

- **StoriesOfUs** is a comprehensive storytelling platform that enables users to share real-life experiences related to social issues including mental health, discrimination, inequality, and social challenges.
- The platform features **user authentication**, **media uploads** (images/videos), **real-time chat**, and a **friends system** for community building.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

- **Lack of Safe Spaces:** Many individuals facing social challenges lack platforms to share experiences without judgment.
- **Awareness Gap:** Social issues often remain hidden due to stigma, preventing community understanding and support.
- **Disconnected Communities:** People experiencing similar challenges often feel isolated, unaware others share their struggles.
- **Need for Anonymity:** Fear of identification prevents many from speaking up about sensitive topics.

KEY FEATURES

📝 Story Features

- **Story Submission:** Share experiences with text
- **Media Uploads:** Add images & videos (up to 5 files)
- **Category Organization:** Filter by topic
- **Anonymous Posting:** Privacy protection

👥 Social Features

- **User Authentication:** Secure login/signup
- **Friends System:** Connect with other users
- **Real-time Chat:** Socket.IO powered messaging
- **Online Status:** See who's online

STORY CATEGORIES

Stories are organized into meaningful categories:

🧠 Mental Health | ✊ Discrimination | ⚖️ Inequality | 🌍 Social Challenges | 📖 Other

Each category helps users find and connect with relevant experiences

USER FLOW

How users interact with StoriesOfUs:

🏠 Visit Home → 📚 Browse Stories → 🔍 Filter → 📖 Read Story → ❤️ Like

✍️ Share Story → 📝 Fill Form → 🏷️ Select Category → ✅ Submit → 🎉 Published!

DATA MODEL

📖 Story

- title, content, author
- category, featured, likes
- **media[]:** {type, url}

👤 User

- name, email
- password
- **friends[]:** User refs

💬 Message

- sender, receiver
- content, read
- createdAt

🏷️ Category

- name, slug
- description, icon
- color

Just MONGODB for Passwords

APPLICATION PAGES

🏠

Home
Featured stories & grid

📚

Stories
Browse & filter

📖

Story Detail
Full view + media

✍️

Submit Story
Form + media upload

🔐

Login
Email & password

📝

Signup
New registration

💬

Chat
Real-time messaging

👥

Friends
Online status & list

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

React Frontend
User Interface

⟷

Express.js
REST API

⟷

Socket.IO
Real-time

⟷

MongoDB
Database

- **Frontend:** React.js + React Router + Context API for state
- **Backend:** Node.js + Express.js + Socket.IO for real-time chat
- **Auth:** MongoDB for password storage
- **Media:** Multer for file uploads (images/videos)

TECHNOLOGY STACK

React.js
Frontend + Router

Node.js
Runtime

Express.js
REST API

MongoDB
Database

Socket.IO
Real-time Chat

Auth
Login/Signup

Multer
File Uploads

Docker
Containerization

API ENDPOINTS

📖 Stories & Categories

- GET /api/stories - List all
- GET /api/stories/:id
- POST /api/stories - Create
- PATCH /api/stories/:id/like
- GET /api/categories

🔐 Authentication

- POST /api/auth/register
- POST /api/auth/login
- GET /api/auth/me

👥 Friends

- GET /api/friends
- GET /api/friends/search
- POST /api/friends/add/:userId
- DELETE /api/friends/remove/:userId

💬 Chat (REST + Socket.IO)

- GET /api/chat/:userId
- POST /api/chat/:userId
- 🔌 user_online, send_message
- 🔌 receive_message, online_users

IMPLEMENTED & FUTURE SCOPE

✅ Implemented

- **User Authentication:** Login/signup ✓
- **Media Uploads:** Images & videos ✓
- **Real-time Chat:** Socket.IO messaging ✓
- **Friends System:** Add & manage friends ✓
- **Modern UI:** Dark theme + glassmorphism ✓

🎯 Future Enhancements

- **Comments:** Story discussions
- **Search:** Full-text search
- **AI Moderation:** Content safety
- **Notifications:** Push alerts
- **Mobile App:** iOS & Android

REFERENCES

- **React.js Documentation** - https://react.dev/
- **Node.js Documentation** - https://nodejs.org/docs/
- **Express.js Guide** - https://expressjs.com/
- **MongoDB Manual** - https://www.mongodb.com/docs/manual/
- **Mongoose ODM** - https://mongoosejs.com/docs/
- **Socket.IO Documentation** - https://socket.io/docs/
- **Multer (File Upload)** - https://github.com/expressjs/multer
- **React Router** - https://reactrouter.com/
- **Docker Documentation** - https://docs.docker.com/
- **MDN Web Docs (CSS/HTML/JS)** - https://developer.mozilla.org/

CONCLUSION

StoriesOfUs bridges the gap between individuals and communities by providing a platform for authentic storytelling about social issues.

Through shared experiences, we build understanding, reduce stigma, and inspire collective action for positive change.

"Every story shared is a step toward a more empathetic world."

Thank You! 🙏

Questions?